

Paper 2 — Are You Ready?

Your 3-Day Exam Prep Checklist

24, 25, 26 April

STEP 1: GRAMMAR (21–22 April)

- I've watched the Grammar playlist on YouTube
- I've attempted all grammar worksheets
- I'm learning 10 vocabulary words / spellings per day (you only need ~50 for exam day)
- I know how to punctuate **transition words** (full stop or semicolon before; comma after)
- I know how to punctuate **dialogue** — both quote-first and quote-later cases
- I've revised common confusables (affect/effect, their/there/they're, etc.)

STEP 2: DIRECTED WRITING (23–24 April)

- I understand what **development** and **evaluation** mean
- I know at least 3 out of 5 ways to develop/evaluate (Result, Experience, Examples, Stats, Alternatives)
- I've tried the PDE worksheet
- I've read all 9 example PDE paragraphs (the middle 3 paras are always the same structure)
- I know the 5 formats (email, letter, speech, report, article) and their layout differences
- I can write a generic plug-in Para 1 for any format
- I can **reword** points from texts in my own words (never copy-paste)
- I know the 6 text-wise evaluation criteria and can use at least **2** in Para 4
- I can use evaluative phrases from memory
- I've attempted 5 yearlies — one of each format — and read the sample answers:
 - Informal email — S25 QP22
 - Speech — W25 QP22
 - Report — W25 QP21
 - Article — W24 QP21
 - Formal letter — S24 QP22

STEP 3: ESSAY WRITING (25 April)

- For narrative writing, I've planned **3 essays** on my own (good start + strong conflict + genuine ending)
- I've gone through the last 3 years' topics and tried fitting my narrative into them
- I have a **skeleton** ready before exam day — it's better to have one!
- I've read 5 sample essays in the notes folder — including their openings and endings
- My essays stay within 400–450 words with 5–6 paragraphs
- I can use vocabulary from the 25-word bank naturally
- I know my sentence templates

GENERAL

- I've checked the exam date, time, and venue
- I have stationery ready (black pens + extras)
- I know how much time to give each section

Quick Notes — Page 1: Grammar

1. HOW TO PUNCTUATE TRANSITION WORDS

Transition words (e.g. *however, therefore, moreover, furthermore, consequently, nevertheless*) connect ideas across sentences. They are **not conjunctions** — they cannot join two clauses with just a comma.

Rule: Full stop OR semicolon before the transition word → comma after it.

She studied hard. **However**, she did not pass.

She studied hard; **however**, she did not pass.

He was exhausted. **Nevertheless**, he continued running.

He was exhausted; **nevertheless**, he continued running.

x WRONG: She studied hard, **however**, she did not pass. (comma splice!)

2. HOW TO PUNCTUATE DIALOGUE

Case 1: Quote First (dialogue before the speaker tag)

The punctuation mark goes **inside** the quotation marks. Use a **comma** (not a full stop) if the sentence continues with a speaker tag.

"I will be there soon," she promised.

"Where are you going?" he asked.

"Stop right there!" the guard shouted.

Note: Question marks and exclamation marks replace the comma — don't add a comma after them.

Case 2: Quote Later (speaker tag before the dialogue)

Use a **comma after the speaker tag**, then open the quotation marks. End punctuation goes **inside** the closing quotes.

She promised, "I will be there soon."

He asked, "Where are you going?"

The guard shouted, "Stop right there!"

3. COMMON CONFUSABLES

Word Pair	How to Remember
affect / effect	Affect = Action (verb) • Effect = End result (noun)
their / there / they're	Their = ownership • There = place • They're = they are
its / it's	Its = belonging to it • It's = it is / it has
your / you're	Your = ownership • You're = you are
to / too / two	To = direction • Too = also/excessive • Two = 2
than / then	Than = comparison • Then = time/sequence
lose / loose	Lose = misplace (verb) • Loose = not tight (adj)
advice / advise	Advice = the suggestion (noun) • Advise = to suggest (verb)
practice / practise	Practice = the activity (noun) • Practise = to do it (verb)
principle / principal	Principle = rule/belief • Principal = head/main
stationary / stationery	Stationary = not moving • Stationery = pens & paper (E for Envelope)

accept / except	Accept = receive/agree • Except = excluding
weather / whether	Weather = climate • Whether = if

daily reminder:

u da goat twn

they simple 'and'

you 'in tandem with'

[yellow font btw]

PARAGRAPH STRUCTURE AT A GLANCE

Para	What Goes Here
Para 1	Generic plug-in introduction — works for ANY format. Sets the context and purpose.
Para 2	4 points from Text A — reworded + developed + evaluated (PDE format).
Para 3	4 points from Text B — 1 evaluated + 3 developed OR all 4 developed.
Para 4	Minimum 2 text-wise evaluations (using 6 criteria) + your final stance.

Para 5: Thank you

THE 6 TEXT-WISE EVALUATION CRITERIA

Use at least 2 of these in your Para 4 to evaluate the texts against each other:

#	Criterion	Quick Reminder
1	Idealistic vs Realistic	One text is hopeful, the other is grounded — the realistic side is stronger.
2	Individual vs Communal	Does the writer only think of themselves, or consider others? Any mention of others = communal.
3	Short-term vs Long-term	One text focuses on immediate results, the other on lasting impact.
4	Use of Statistics	Does either text back up claims with data/numbers?
5	Age / Authority	Does the writer's age or expertise make their argument more or less convincing?
6	Bias	Does either writer show one-sidedness or personal agenda?

5 FORMAT DIFFERENCES

Format	Opening	Tone	Key Layout Feature
Informal Email	Hi [Name],	Casual, friendly	Subject line + sign-off (e.g. Take care, [Name])
Formal Letter	Dear Sir/Madam, Dear Mr/Ms [Name],	Formal, polite	Sender address + date + Yours faithfully/sincerely
Speech	Good morning everyone...	Persuasive, engaging	Rhetorical questions + direct address (you, we)
Report	Report on: [Title] Prepared by: [Name]	Objective, factual	Subheadings + recommendations section
Article	Headline + By [Name]	Informative, opinionated	Catchy headline + strong conclusion

> Only difference between letter and email is subject line and ending line.

Quick Notes — Page 3: Essay Writing

3 ESSAY TYPES — KNOW YOUR PATTERN

Type	Theme	Structure Pattern
Type A	Surprise / Discovery / Joy	Calm opening → builds curiosity → big reveal / joyful moment → reflection
Type B	Mistake / Conflict / Accusation	Tension opening → rising conflict → confrontation / mistake → consequence + lesson
Type C	Personal Challenge / Sacrifice / Memory	Reflective opening → struggle described → turning point / sacrifice → emotional resolution

OPENING & ENDING TYPES

Strong Openings:

- **In medias res** — Start in the middle of the action. *"The glass shattered before I could even scream."*
- **Sensory snapshot** — Begin with a vivid image/sound/smell. *"The air tasted of rust and rain."*
- **Dialogue hook** — Open with speech that pulls the reader in. *"You have exactly five minutes," he whispered."*
- **Reflective** — Start from the future looking back. *"If I had known what that morning would bring..."*

Strong Endings:

- **Full circle** — Echo the opening image or line with new meaning.
- **Lesson / reflection** — The character shares what they learned.
- **Quiet moment** — End on a calm, emotional image (not a dramatic twist).
- **Open-ended** — Leave the reader thinking. *"And for the first time, I didn't look back."*

DOS & DON'TS FROM THE EXAMINER

✓ DO	✗ DON'T
Plan before you write — even 3 minutes helps	Don't start writing without a plan
Stay within 400–450 words	Don't go over 500 words — you'll rush the ending
Use 5–6 labelled paragraphs	Don't write in 1–2 giant blocks
Use vocabulary naturally — not forced	Don't stuff in big words that don't fit
Have a clear conflict/turning point	Don't write a flat 'and then... and then' story
End with meaning — reflection or emotion	Don't end with 'It was all a dream' or 'I woke up'
Vary your sentence lengths	Don't write only long, complex sentences
Show, don't tell — use sensory details	Don't just say 'I was sad' — describe it

Remember: It's better to have a skeleton ready before exam day. Plan your 3 essays, fit them to past topics, and walk in with confidence!